Paróiste Naomh Fionán

8Ú SAMHAIN 2026 – AN DARA DOMHNACH TRÍOCHAD – A

Reflection



A frequent biblical image for God's homecoming is that of a wedding feast. This is an image that recurs in many of the parables of Jesus, and we come across it in today's gospel reading from Matthew, which recounts the parable of the wise and the foolish bridesmaids. A bit of background may help us to understand this parable. According to Jewish custom, the role of bridesmaids was to accompany and help the bride to prepare for the wedding. Bridesmaids would often wait with the bride in her home until the groom arrived and then joyfully escort the bridal couple with lighted lamps to the bridegroom's home, where the marriage ceremony and subsequent feast would take place. And the feast would last for several days.
In the parable of Jesus, there are ten bridesmaids. Five of them are foolish and five are wise. Because of a lengthy delay in the bridegroom's arrival, the five foolish bridesmaids run out of oil and rush to town to purchase more. In their absence, the bridegroom arrives and the wise bridesmaids, who had brought extra oil with them, are ready to accompany the groom and his bride to the wedding feast. When the foolish bridesmaids eventually arrive at the wedding hall and beg to be admitted, they are turned away with the words, 'Truly I tells you, I do not know you' (Mt 25:12). The meaning of the parable seems fairly clear. It is telling us to be always ready to welcome the Lord into our lives whenever he comes. Jesus ends the parable with the warning, 'Keep awake, therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour' (Mt 25:13).
We should always be ready to meet the Lord when he calls us.

Cuimhneacháin Báis:
Georgina McBride, Ray, whose funeral took place during the week,

Anniversaries:
Nora Gallagher and deceased family members, Baltoney.

Mass Times and Intentions for the Week

Saturday 7th	**7: 00 pm**	Novena	
Sunday 8th	**9: 00 am**	Aifreann don Phobal	
	10: 30 am	Novena	
Monday 9th	**7: 00 pm**	Novena	
Tuesday 10th	**7: 00 pm**	Novena	
Wednesday 11th	**9: 30 am**	Private Intention	
Thursday 12th	**9: 30 am**	Private Intention	
Friday 13th	**7: 00 pm**	Nora Gallagher and deceased family members	Anniversaries
Saturday 14th	**11: 00 am**	Latin Mass	
	7: 00 pm	Mary Sweeney	Anniversary
		Nora McGinley	Anniversary
Sunday 15th	**9: 00 am**	Aifreann don Phobal	
	10: 30 am	Phil Gallagher	Anniversary

Please scan the QR code below to donate to either Falcarragh Church or Graveyard Collection

Church Collection

Graveyard Collection

Confessions
6:15pm—6:45pm
Saturdays

Eucharistic Adoration
Wednesday:
Holy Hour: 8– 9 pm
Thursday: 10: 00 am – 9: 00 pm.
Thursday adoration includes the Divine Mercy @ 5: 30 pm and concludes with Rosary @ 8: 30 pm

All Masses are available live on:
www.naomhfionan.com
& Parish Radio @ 106.5 FM

Fr. John Boyce P.P.
Parochial House, Falcarragh, Co. Donegal. F92 N6Y9.
074 91 35196 I fionannewsletter@gmail.com



Fógraí

Freagra an tSailm:
Tá tart ar m'anam chugat, a Thiarna, a Dhia liom.

HOW TO REPORT CLERICAL ABUSE
If you have a concern, or complaint of child abuse, either current or historical, please contact:
Designated Liaison Person, Margaret Northage on: 086 2183 011 or by email: safeguarding@raphoediocese.ie.
You are advised also to contact statutory authorities:
Tusla (Child & Family Agency) - Tel: 074 9102233
Gardaí National Protective Services Bureau - Tel: 01 6663430/6663435 or email: GNPSB_SCMU@garda.ie.
Free Counselling & Support is available through Towards Healing:
Freephone - RoI: 1800 303416
Freephone - N.Ireland & UK: 0800 0963315
Freephone - Hearing Impaired: 085 8022859

Ways to donate to parish funds
You can now make a donation to the Parish online by scanning the QR codes on the front of this newsletter, with your mobile phone camera. One QR code is for the Sunday Collection and one QR code is for the Graveyard Collection. You can also make donations by going to the parish website and clicking on the DONATE button. All donations are gratefully accepted.

November Novena for the Holy Souls
The annual Novena will run from Monday 2nd – Tuesday 10th November. Masses for the Novena will be at 7pm daily and on Sunday morning at 10:30 am. Please use the envelopes available in the Church porches for lists of your deceased that you wish to have included in the Novena, and return to the letterbox beside the Sacristy Door in the Church. If you wish to have someone included in the Novena, please drop their names into the letterbox before the Mass on Monday. The envelopes will then be placed on the altar for the duration of the Novena.

Indulgences at the Commemoration of Holy Souls 2nd November
From 12 o' clock noon on 1st November until midnight on 2nd November, all who have confessed, received Holy Communion and prayed for the Pope's intentions (one Our Father and Hail Mary, or any other prayer of one's choice) can gain one plenary indulgence by visiting a church or oratory and there reciting one Our Father and the Apostles' Creed. This indulgence is applicable only to the souls of the departed. Confession may be made at any time within the week preceding or the week following 1st November. Holy Communion may be received on any day from 1st to 8th November.
The faithful who visit a cemetery and pray for the dead may gain a plenary indulgence applicable only to the Holy Souls on the usual conditions once per day from 1st to 8th November. The conditions mentioned above apply also for this.

Aifreann Cuimhneacháin
There will be a Mass in Christ The King Church, Gortahork, for families who have lost someone or people in road accidents on Sunday 15/11/2026 at 11.00 a.m. send an email to tpcr1906@gmail.com to add their name to the prayer list before Friday 30/10/2026.

Raphoe Diocesan Society
In November of each year an Annual Mass for the deceased Members of the Society will be offered in a different parish. The Annual Raphoe Diocesan Society Mass will be celebrated by Most Rev Niall Coll , Bishop of Raphoe, on Tuesday 17th November 2026 at 7:30 pm in St Columba's Church, Glenswilly. Four Masses (of Perpetual Foundation) shall be offered in each parish each year - two for the living and two for the deceased Members of the Society. To enrol a member deceased or living to the Society contact your local Priest or by emailing rds@raphoediocese.ie with the details. Cost per enrolment is €15 per person, living or deceased.

Pilgrimage to Medjugorje
Departing 8th September 2027 from CITY OF DERRY AIRPORT for 8 nights for the price of 7 with Spiritual Director. Cost €929 per person.
EARLY BOOKING OFFER €100 OFF if paid in full by December 2026.
For further information and to book contact
Mairead - 087-7698195 or Kathleen - 086-3721962.

Easter pilgrimage to Medjugorje
March 2027Ex Dublin 6 nights. Spiritual Director Fr Brennan.
More info from Bernie McBride @ 087 935 3953.

Flu Clinic
Falcarragh Medical Centre will be holding a Flu Vaccination clinic on Monday 23rd November please call the surgery to make an appointment, 0749135491/35490. On the day it would be advisable to wear short sleeves for ease of access.

Food Bank Appeal
The Food Bank is in dire straits at the moment, very low on supplies, so non perishable goods are very urgently required. Food bins have been left in the 4 porches for any goods donated. If anyone needs help please contact us on 085 7560177 or call on Thursday mornings between 10am and 12pm.

Coiste Glan agus Glas
Coiste Glan agus Glas, Falcarragh Tidy Towns group are delighted to have been awarded an additional 21 marks in this year's competition giving us a total of 362 this year. Táimid fíor bhuioch as tacaíocht an phobail. A special thanks to Kevin and the CE Scheme workers and to all the volunteers who give of their time on a regular basis. Go raibh maith agaibh uilig.

Electrical Recycling Day.
Free Electrical Recycling Day in Falcarragh, Saturday 7th November 10am - 4 pm. Denis McCallion's Yard, Opposite Cassidy's Quarry

Innovate+
Innovate+ is a new initiative led by ATU Donegal. If you are a small business interested in Innovation/business growth, we are running funded training for you or your staff. To find about more about our current offerings, email pauline.gavigan@atu.ie or phone 0749186612..

Buíon Cheoil Sinsear Chloich Cheann Fhaola
Buíon Cheoil Sinsear Chloich Cheann Fhaola will hold their AGM on Saturday 7th November, in Ionad Naomh Fionnán Falcarragh at 8pm.

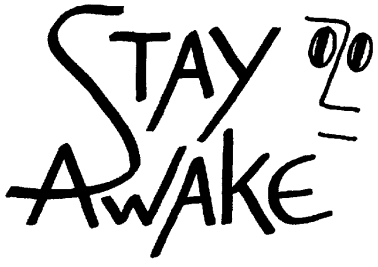
CLG Chloich Cheann Fhaola
Tickets are available in various outlets throughout the parish and online at the following link
https://clubforce.com/clubs/gaa-clg-chloich-cheann-fhaola/

Cloughaneely Junior Band
Lotto Results 29th October
Uimhreacha na seachtaine: 2-4-5-14-16-18
Match 5 winner: Marie Lynch €100. Jackpot €4,100.

Parish Newsletter
All notices for inclusion in newsletter to be in by 11 am on Thursdays. Thank you.

Dates for Diary 2027

First Holy Communion:	Saturday 1st May @ 12:00 noon
Confirmation:	Sunday 14th February @ 11: 00 am
Graveyard Sunday:	Sunday 1st August @ 1: 00 pm



St. Vincent de Paul: Local number: 087 1443464
Cloughaneely Food Bank: 085 7560177
MABS Gweedore: 0818 072650